

3,280–13,123 ft (1,000–4,000 m)

Midnight zone

This zone is in total darkness. Huge pressure comes from the heavy water above, but some animals, such as jellyfish, have soft bodies, which stop them from being crushed.



Footballfish



Big red jellyfish



Frilled shark



Dumbo octopus

13,123–19,685 ft (4,000–6,000 m)

Abyss

Meaning “bottomless” in Greek, the abyss is freezing cold. The amount of water above it means that this zone has a level of pressure that is hundreds of times greater than on the surface.



Sea pig



Hagfish



Tripod fish

Below 19,685 ft (6,000 m)

Hadal

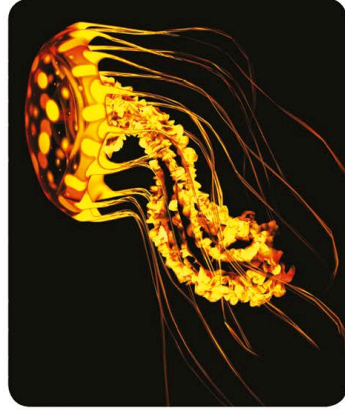
The deepest and darkest depths of the ocean in the hadal zone are almost empty. Food is in short supply, so marine life down here eats bacteria and waste material, which falls to the ocean floor.



Giant tube worm

Bioluminescent fish

Some animals in the deeper zones have adapted to the darkness by using chemicals in their bodies to create their own light—this is called bioluminescence. Glowing in the dark allows them to recognize each other, catch prey, and scare away predators.



Brilliant bioluminescent jellyfish